

Computational Thinking

Discrete Mathematics

Number Theory

Topic 00 : Module Introduction

Logic

Lecture 01 : Module Overview

Dr Kieran Murphy   

Computing and Mathematics, SETU (Waterford).
(kieran.murphy@setu.ie)

Graphs and
Networks

Autumn Semester, 2026/27

Collections

Outline

- Motivation and aim of this module.
- Administration trivia — Contact hours, Assessment structure, ...
- Resources

Enumeration

Relations & Functions

Outline

1. Module Introduction	2
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What?

(Aim)

Aim, as per the Module Descriptor ...

This module provides a solid foundation of selected topics in discrete mathematics related to computing and information sciences. The topics are covered in an elementary manner in order to reinforce understanding of concepts and improving algebraic problem-solving skills so that the student can effectively proceed with their study of a degree programme in computing.

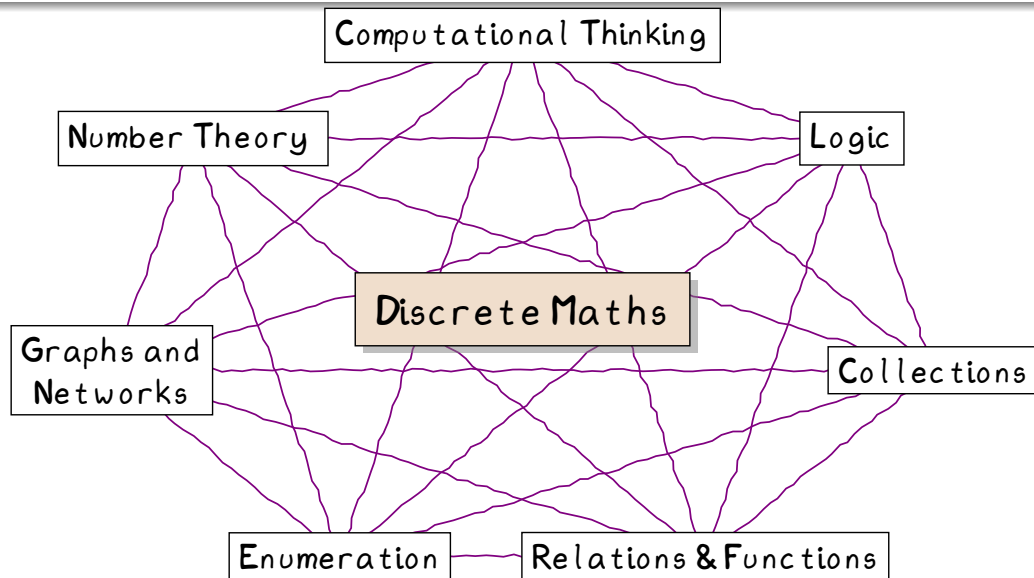
Translation (Informal Aims)

- 1 Reason logically — aim for precision and correctness over speed.
- 2 Develop and manipulate theoretical models
— a **set** is a collection of things, a **relation** is a collection of pairs of things, a **graph** is a collection of things with pairwise connections, etc..
- 3 Translate

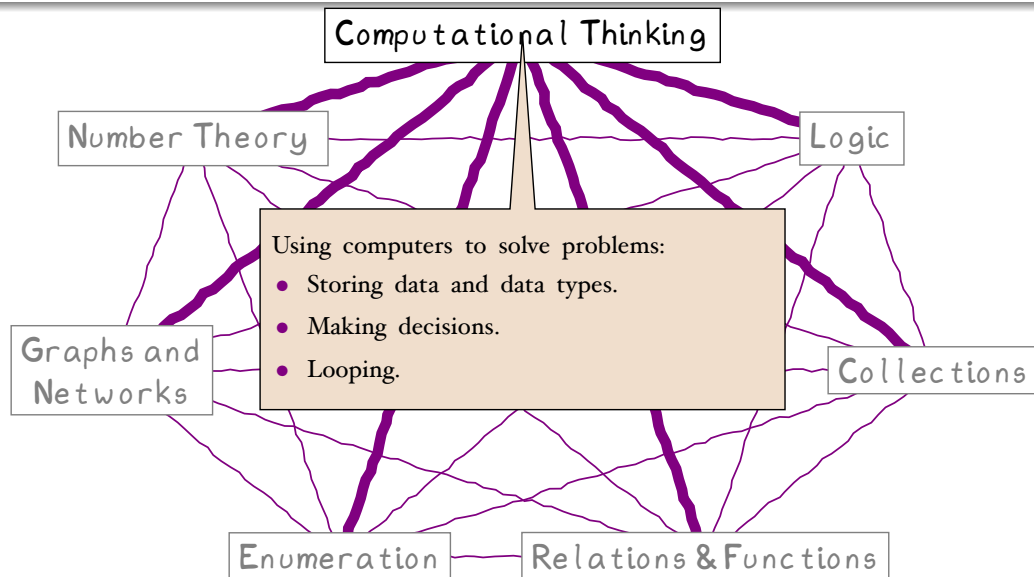
computing concepts/implementation (Python) ↔ theoretical models (mathematics).

What?

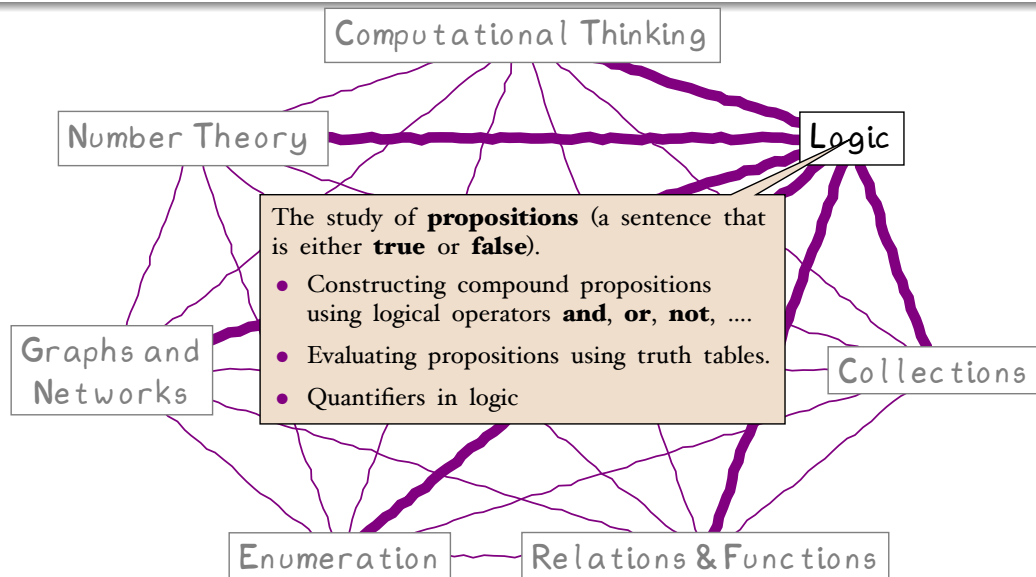
(Discrete Mathematics)



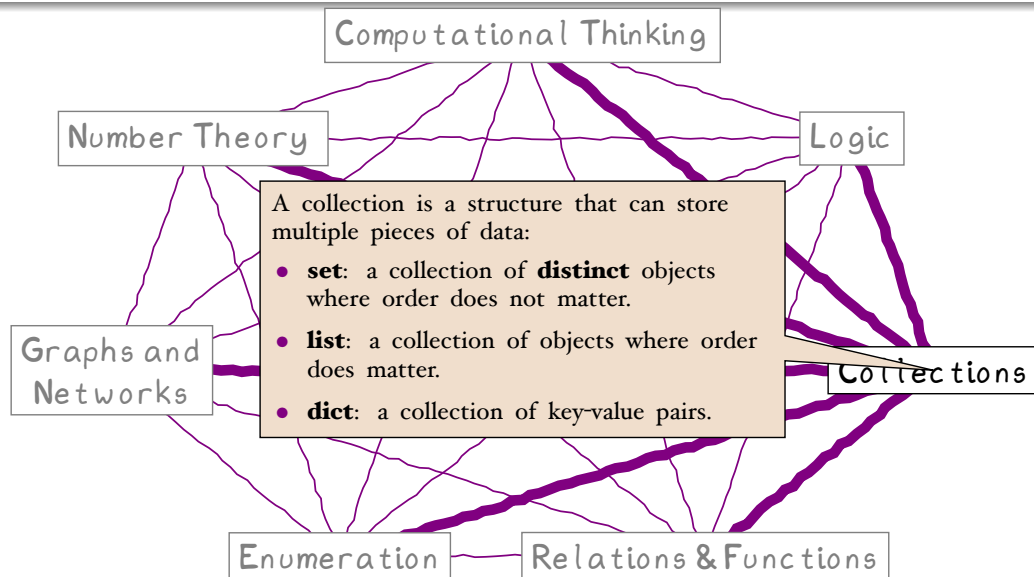
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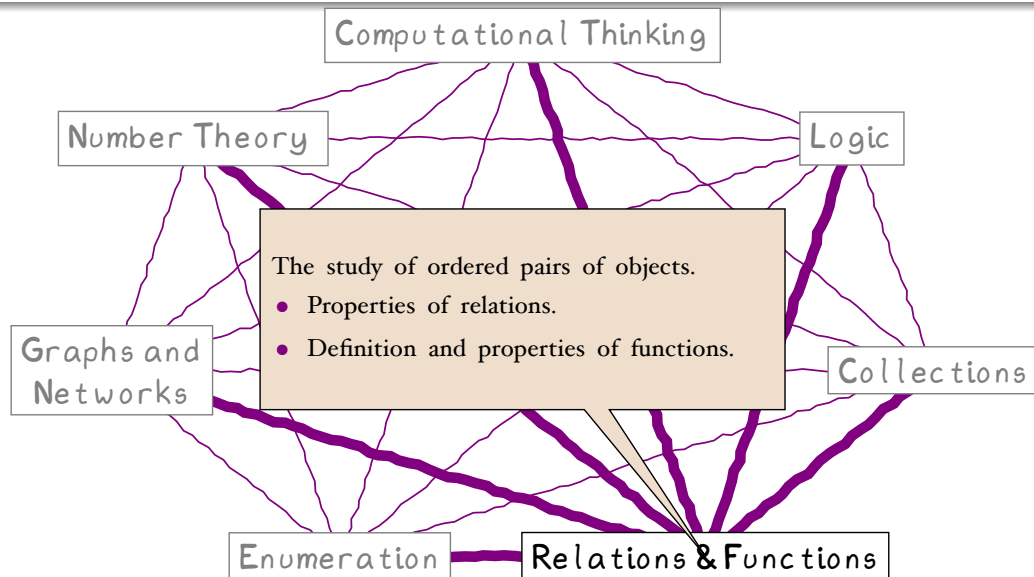
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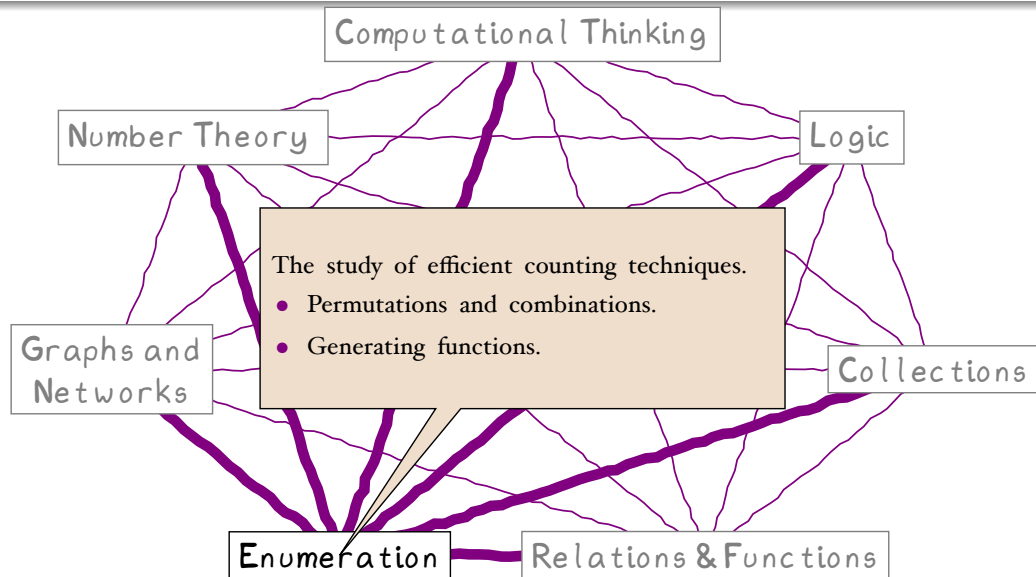
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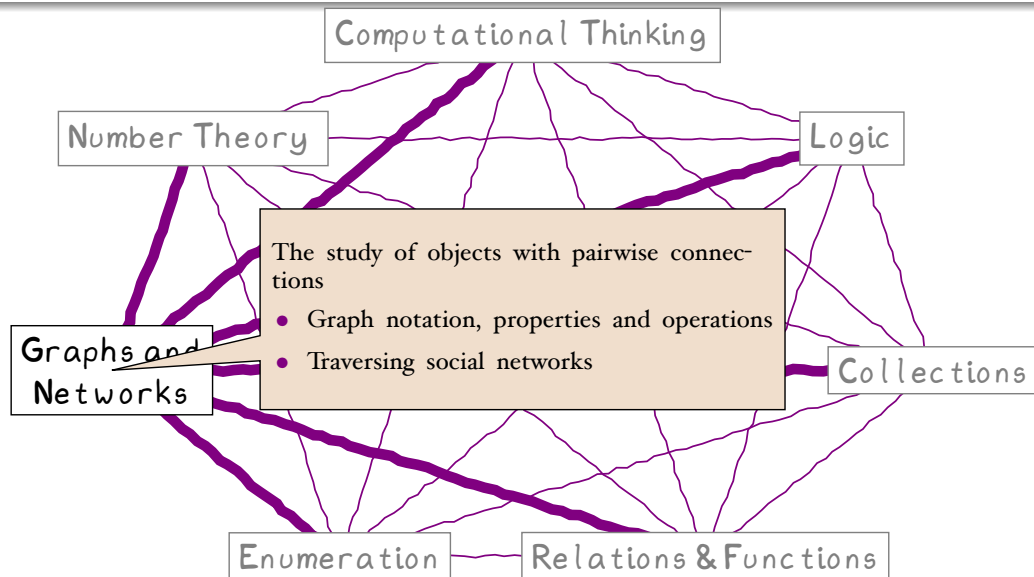
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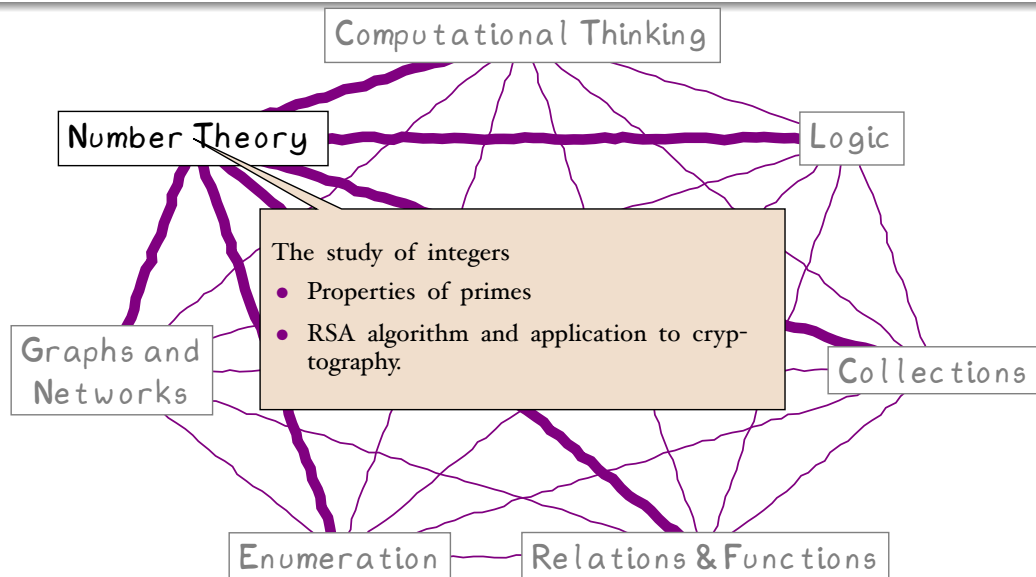
What?



What?



What?



Why?

Many, many reasons ... picking one* ...

AI / Machine learning is the future of computing

Discrete mathematics is the core of machine learning.

Why?

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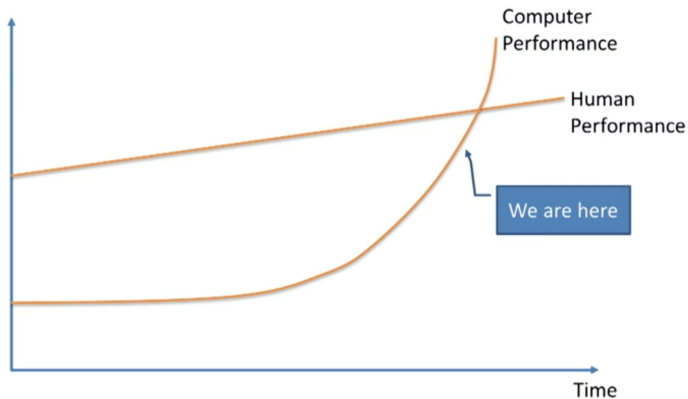
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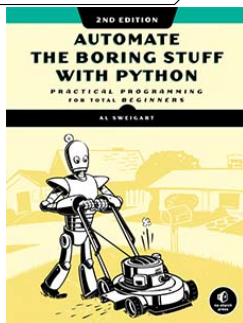
Why?

(Aim)

Computers are faster and more accurate* than us, they don't get board/distracted†

⇒ Get computers to do the hard (and/or boring) stuff

See Al Sweigart's books



Or our view on life



Why have a dog and bark?

Exception to this are the generative text models (chatGPT, Bard, ...) where accuracy is replaced by "most likely/probable".

†Well, if you don't count Teslas, in FSD mode, driving over pedestrians ...

Aside: Speaking of Elon ... AI and all that ...

List of predictions for autonomous Tesla vehicles by Elon Musk

From Wikipedia, the free encyclopedia

Date ↕	Prediction ↕	Quote	Met ↕
Sep 2013	2016	"We should be able to do 90 percent of miles driven [autonomously] within three years."	✗ No
Jun 2014	2015	"I am confident that in less than a year you will be able to go from highway on ramp to highway exits without touching any controls."	✗ No
Oct 2014	2015	"A Tesla car next year will probably be 90-percent capable of autopilot. Like, so 90 percent of your miles can be on auto. For sure highway travel."	AP/HW1 released Oct 2015 for highways^[7]
Oct 2014	2023	"I think we'll be able to achieve true autonomous driving, where you could literally get in the car, go to sleep and wake up at your destination,"	✗ No
Oct 2015	2018	"From a technology standpoint, Tesla will have a car that can do full autonomy in about three years, maybe a bit sooner."	✗ No

Dec 2015	2018	"We're going to end up with complete autonomy, and I think we will have complete autonomy in approximately two years."	✗ No
Jan 2016	2018	"Ultimately you'll be able to summon your car anywhere ... your car can get to you. I think that within two years, you'll be able to summon your car from across the country. It will meet you wherever your phone is ... and it will just automatically charge itself along the entire journey."	✗ No
Jun 2016	2019	"I consider autonomous driving to be a basically solved problem. ... We're less than two years away from complete autonomy. Regulators however will take at least another year; they'll want to see billions of miles of	✗ No

How?

(Contact Hours)

⚙️ Three lectures per week

- ⚙️ Cover concepts, definitions, examples, etc.

- ⚙️ BUT feel free to stop me and ask questions at any point.

- ⚠️ **You should print out notes in advance of lecture, or have access to them during class.**

- ⚙️ Ideally you skimmed over the notes in advance of lecture.

- ⚠️ **Take notes during lectures.**

⚙️ One tutorial per week

- ⚙️ Review of exercises based on the material covered in the lectures.

- ⚠️ **You need to have printout of tutorial sheets in advance of lecture.**

- ⚙️ Ideally you have attempted/completed some/all questions in advance of tutorial and you are just attending the tutorials to show off.

- ⚙️ Online quiz for self review at end of each topic.

⚙️ One practical per week

- ⚙️ Using Python (via *colab notebooks*) to demonstrate implementation details of discrete mathematics concepts.

- ⚙️ Introduce programming in Python — never have too much programming.

- ⚠️ **You need to upload notebook by end of week (Saturday 11:00pm).**

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How?

(Assessment Structure)

75% End of Semester Exam

Current plan (this is subject to change so ask about this in week 10!)

- 4 questions (typically 3–5 parts per question. Answer all questions (i.e. no choice).
- Tend not to have question per topic.
- 80% same material as last year — but there may still be some differences in format/style of questions as will the relative emphasis/weighting of the different topics.

25% Continuous Assessment

- Practical work based on 10 python practicals and 2+ online class tests[‡].
- In theory[§], weekly assignments, are graded in advance of next week.

[§]In practice, I ~~may~~ will fall behind a bit.

Who?

Dr Denis Flynn

📠 Room 327
☎ 051-30 2068
✉ Denis.Flynn@setu.ie



Background

- PhD in Applied Mathematics and Civil Engineering.
- BSc (H) Physics.

Academic Interests

- Dynamical systems, in particular systems with hysteresis
- Game development
- Languages: C/C++, Python, Java

Dr Kieran Murphy

📠 Room 313
☎ 051-30 2055
✉ Kieran.Murphy@setu.ie



Background

- PhD in Applied Mathematical Sciences
- BSc (H) Applied Mathematics.

Academic Interests

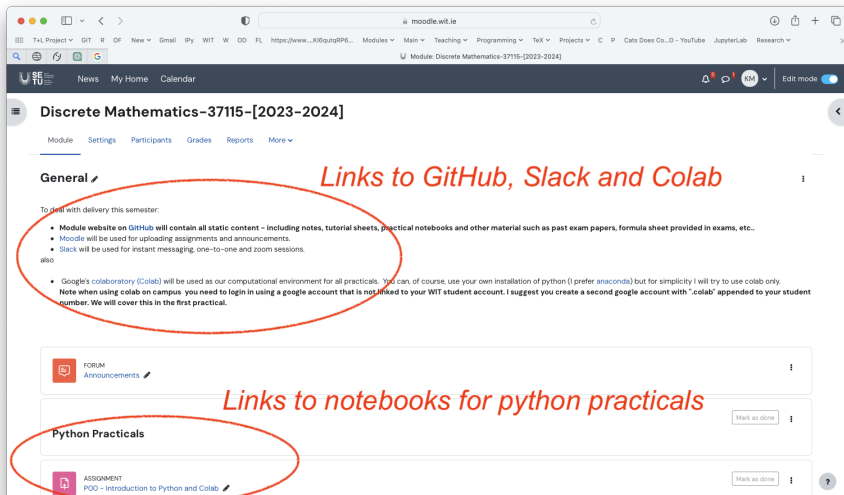
- Dynamical systems, in particular numerical analysis
- Game development
- Languages: C/C++, Python, Java

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Resources — Moodle

- URL: moodle.wit.ie/course/view.php?id=226896
- Used for all notices, assignment and practical work submissions.



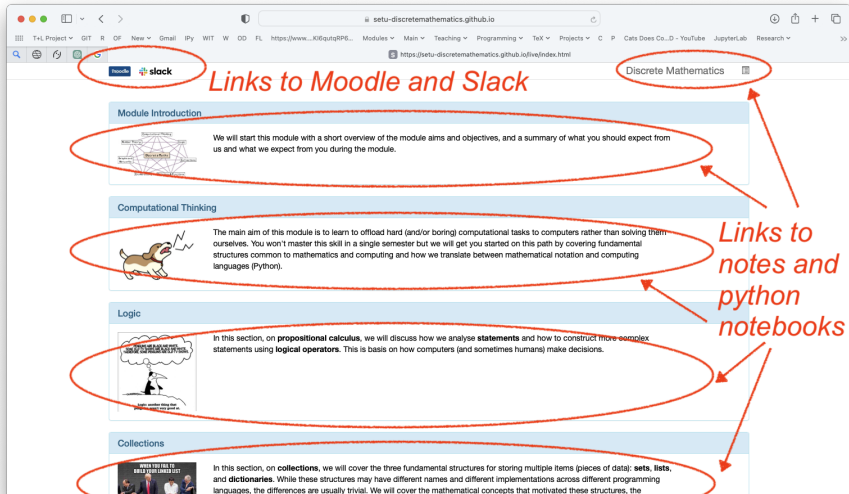
The screenshot shows the Moodle course page for Discrete Mathematics-37115-[2023-2024]. The page has a dark blue header with navigation links like News, My Home, and Calendar. Below the header, the course title is displayed, followed by tabs for Module, Settings, Participants, Grades, Reports, and More. The 'General' section is active, showing a list of links to GitHub, Slack, and Colab, which are circled in red. Below this, there is a section for 'Python Practicals' with a link to notebooks for python practicals, also circled in red. The page also includes a 'FORUM' section with 'Announcements' and an 'ASSIGNMENT' section with 'POO - Introduction to Python and Colab'.

Links to GitHub, Slack and Colab

Links to notebooks for python practicals

Resources — Github

- URL: [SETU-DiscreteMathematics.github.io/live](https://setu-discretemathematics.github.io/live)
- Used for all content (slides, notebooks, tutorial sheets).



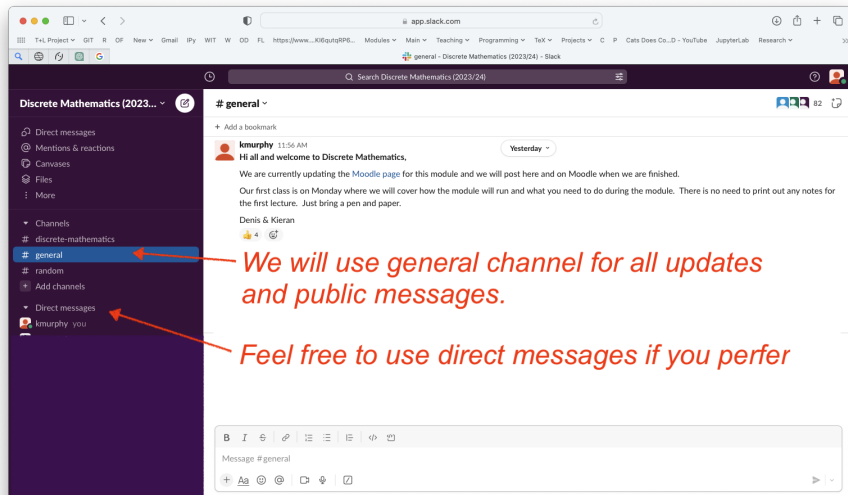
The screenshot shows the website [setu-discretemathematics.github.io](https://setu-discretemathematics.github.io/live) in a browser. The browser's address bar and tabs are visible at the top. The website content is organized into sections, each with a blue header and a light blue background. Red circles and arrows highlight specific elements:

- A red circle around the Slack icon in the top navigation bar, with a red arrow pointing to the text "Links to Moodle and Slack".
- A red circle around the "Discrete Mathematics" link in the top right corner, with a red arrow pointing to the text "Links to notes and python notebooks".
- A red circle around the "Module Introduction" section, which includes a diagram of a network and a paragraph of text.
- A red circle around the "Computational Thinking" section, which includes a cartoon of a dog and a paragraph of text.
- A red circle around the "Logic" section, which includes a cartoon of a person thinking and a paragraph of text.
- A red circle around the "Collections" section, which includes a cartoon of a person and a paragraph of text.

The text "Links to notes and python notebooks" is written in red and points to the "Discrete Mathematics" link and the "Logic" section.

Resources — Slack

- URL: discretemathe-7co3349.slack.com
- Used for instant messaging, one-on-one sessions, etc.



Resources — Colab

- We will use the online Google Colab[¶] environment to code in python for all of our practical work.
- You can open a notebook from these slides by clicking the "OPEN in COLAB" icon or clicking/scanning the QR code



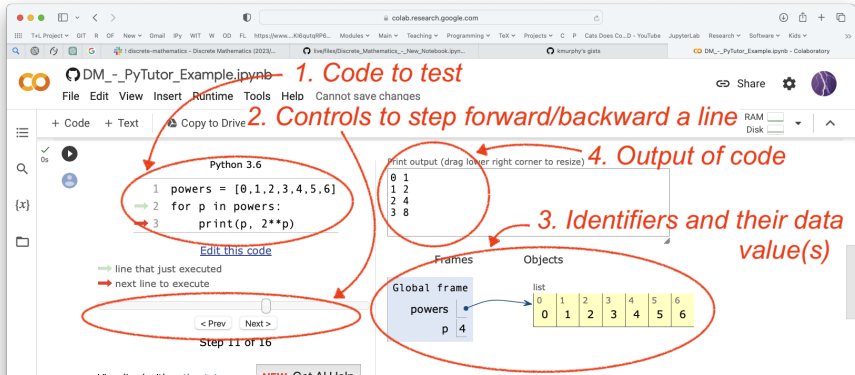
Since using Colab is such a large part of our module we have a separate set of slides covering using Colab in more detail.



[¶]Alternatively, if you want to install python on your laptop you could use the anaconda distribution from www.anaconda.com (just install the latest 64-bit, version 3.+).

Resources — PyTutor

- PyTutor (pythontutor.com) is a website that helps programmers to learn Python, Javascript, C/C++, and Java by visualising code execution (shows what happens to data as code runs, line by line).
- We will run PyTutor from within Colab so will demo PyTutor when we cover Colab (or click/scan the QR code).

The screenshot shows the PyTutor interface within a Google Colab notebook. The interface includes a code editor, a runtime control panel, and a visual representation of the program's state.

1. Code to test: The code being executed is:

```
Python 3.6
1 powers = [0,1,2,3,4,5,6]
2 for p in powers:
3     print(p, 2**p)
```

2. Controls to step forward/backward a line: The runtime control panel includes buttons for "< Prev" and "Next >".

3. Identifiers and their data value(s): The "Frames" section shows the "Global frame" with variables "powers" and "p". The "Objects" section shows a "list" object containing the values [0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6].

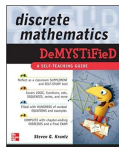
4. Output of code: The "Print output" section displays the results of the code execution:

```
0 1
1 2
2 4
3 8
```

Text Books

I

I like the following textbooks on discrete mathematics and expect that my notes will overlap significantly with these books. I do encourage you to read* them[†], however, be aware they may use different notation or cover different topics.



Discrete Mathematics Demystified

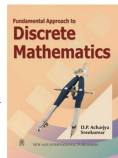
by Steven Krantz

Touches on nearly all of the topics that we hope to cover. We will probably go into greater depth in places, but a very nice and short read.

Fundamental Approach to Discrete Mathematics

by D. P. Acharjya Sreekumar

I also liked this book, however, due to time constraints, this module only focuses on material in chapter 1–4, 8, and 10.



*or skim them over a coffee or two.

[†]I also like *Applied Discrete Structures* by Alan Doerr and Kenneth Levasseur — it is a good source of exercises. (and is free (legally))

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Final Comments on Module

- Discrete Mathematics concepts appear either directly or indirectly in approximately 22 of the 30 modules on your degree.
 $\implies$ *Knowing Discrete Mathematics concepts greatly simplifies rest of the course.*
- The module is intended to be an introduction to a large number of topics, so treatment is broad rather than deep.
 - ✓ Most of material is at an introductory level.
 - ⚠ Keeping in sync with material, practicals and tutorials is important.
- The continuous assessment (the practicals) is intended to reinforce the connections between programming and discrete mathematics.

The CA is a “carrot not a stick” — we want you to enjoy the module and keep up to date with the material.

